

Build Steps

Cowork is task-driven — give Copilot a job, optionally schedule it, let it use your M365.

1 Open Copilot Cowork

Open Microsoft 365 Copilot and switch to Cowork mode (left rail). Confirm the surfaces you have available — Cowork can act on your behalf across:

- Outlook (read, summarise, draft, send, schedule)
- Teams (chats, channels, post messages, read history)
- Calendar (find times, create meetings, prep briefs)
- SharePoint & OneDrive (read files, write Word/Excel/PowerPoint to your files)
- Power BI (semantic models, reports, DAX queries)

2 Paste the Headline Task

Open a new Cowork task and paste the prompt below. This is the worked example for Public & Regulated — SLA Risk — adapt names, channels, and Power BI reports to your tenant before running.

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Every day at 9:00am, run the SLA Risk Alerts task:

1. Do NOT send/post automatically – leave the draft for me to review. All citizen-facing communication is draft-only.
2. Open PublicSector_Cases_Data.xlsx from /Casework/ in SharePoint. Read every row where Status is New or In progress.
3. For each open case, compute SLA Remaining = SLA_Days - DaysOpen.
4. Categorise:
   Breached (SLA Remaining < 0)
   At-risk (0 ≤ SLA Remaining ≤ 2)
   On-track (SLA Remaining > 2)
5. Within each category, sort by Priority (High → Med → Low), then by oldest SubmittedDate.
6. Capture per case: CaseID, Category, CitizenReferenceCode, Channel, Priority, SubmittedDate, DaysOpen, SLA Remaining, AssignedTo, Summary (one line).
7. Build a Word brief saved to /Casework/Daily/SLA_<date>.docx: counts by status, the Breached and At-risk tables in full, and a Caseworker Workload table (open cases per AssignedTo, highlighting anyone above 15).
8. Draft a Teams message to the 'Case Triage' channel: counts, link to the brief, and a 'Today's Priority' shortlist of the top 5 Breached cases. Leave as draft.
9. For every Breached or At-risk case, draft a plain-language acknowledgement letter to the citizen (use CitizenReferenceCode as salutation token, no internal jargon, reading level suitable for general public). Save drafts to /Casework/Drafts/<CaseID>.docx – do NOT email or post.
10. For every AssignedTo with a Breached case, draft a short, neutral Teams DM listing their breached CaseIDs and a 'please update Status or escalate' ask. Leave drafts.
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3 Set the Schedule

In the task panel, choose Schedule and configure:

Frequency	Daily
Run Time	09:00 local (start of casework day)
Execution Mode	Inline (recommended) — task remembers context across runs

4 Verify the First Run

Run once now (Run now) before scheduling kicks in. Confirm:

- Breached / At-risk / On-track counts add up to total open cases
- Priority sort within categories is correct — High first
- Acknowledgement letters read at plain-language level (no jargon, no acronyms)
- Every citizen-facing draft uses CitizenReferenceCode, never any other identifier

Try These Live

Copy any of these into a new Cowork task — one-shot or scheduled.

Channel-Volume Read

Across the last 30 days, count cases by Channel (Web / Phone / Walk-in / Post) and by Category. Identify any channel-category combo trending up >30% versus the prior 30 days. Build a one-page Word brief for the Service Lead with the table and 2 service-design questions to discuss at the next ops meeting.

Reassignment Suggestion

From the workbook, list every caseworker (AssignedTo) with more than 15 open cases. For each, identify 3 of their lowest-Priority, longest-DaysOpen cases that could move to a colleague with capacity. Draft a Teams DM to the team lead with the suggested moves. Leave as draft.

Category Acknowledgement Templates

For each Category (Housing / Benefits / Permits / Complaints / Info), generate a reusable plain-language acknowledgement template — placeholders for CaseID, CitizenReferenceCode, expected next step, contact route. Save to /Casework/Templates/. These become the seed for future drafts.

Citizen Recontact Log

From my mailbox for the last 14 days, find replies from citizens that quote a CitizenReferenceCode. Match each back to a CaseID in the workbook. Build a list of cases where the citizen has chased twice or more. Draft a Teams DM to the AssignedTo asking for an updated reply. Leave drafts.

How to Think About This Teammate

Cowork replaces:

- Caseworkers discovering SLA breaches mid-afternoon
- Inconsistent acknowledgement letters per worker
- Workload imbalance noticed only at week's end

With:

- ✓ A 9am breach & at-risk shortlist by Priority
- ✓ Plain-language acknowledgements ready for review
- ✓ Reassignment suggestions before the day starts

Not a chatbot. A scheduled teammate with full access to your M365.

Tip for real-world use

Public & regulated work demands plain language. Write citizen-facing drafts at general-public reading level — no acronyms, no jargon, no system field names. Pair with strict draft-only output; the regulator-friendly audit trail is the human-review step itself.

You've built a Cowork teammate ✓

You now have a Copilot teammate that can:

- Catch SLA breaches the morning they happen
- Draft acknowledgements without copy-paste
- Rebalance caseworker load with real data
- Hold a plain-language bar across every reply